Small Moments, Big Trust

Small Moments, Big Trust



TIMING: 1:00 | 0:00–1:00

SESSION: Target 13 minutes, including brief discussion. For 12 minutes, take one response per prompt. For 15 minutes, allow one additional example.

SAY:

Welcome to today's Nurse Leader Huddle. In a busy week, a follow-up message or a few minutes of attention can be easy to postpone. Those everyday interactions help shape whether people trust us.

ASK:

Think of a leader you trusted. What small thing did that person consistently do?

FACILITATE:

Pause for 15 seconds and invite one brief response. Listen for follow-through, attention, honest updates, or ownership of mistakes.

SAY:

Today we will look at reliability, presence, and accountability, then choose one action to complete within the next 48 hours.

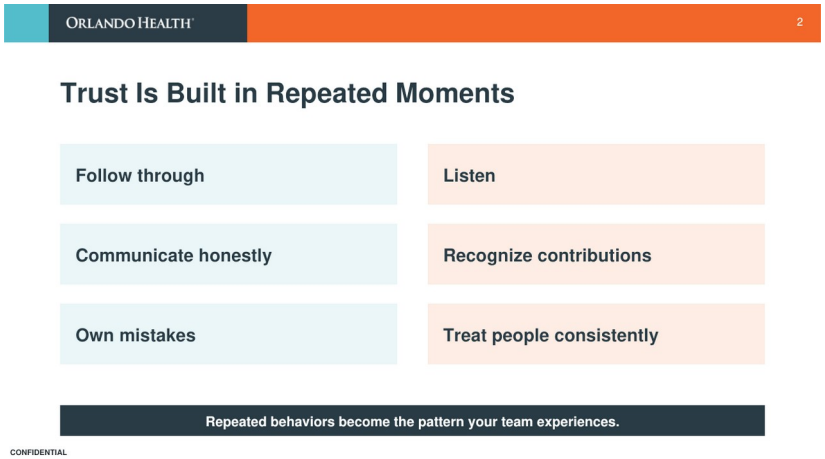
TRANSITION:

Trust develops through the patterns people experience in ordinary moments.

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Trust Is Built in Repeated Moments



TIMING: 1:20 | 1:00–2:20

SAY:

Many of the behaviors that build trust seem small. Following through on a commitment. Acknowledging someone's contribution.

Providing an honest update. Owning a mistake. Treating people consistently.

Individually, these moments may appear minor, yet each contributes to how people experience their leader.

But your team is not evaluating them individually. Over time, they become patterns. And those patterns shape trust.

TRANSITION:

Let's explore why these seemingly small behaviors matter so much.

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Small Behaviors Send Big Messages



TIMING: 1:15 | 2:20–3:35

SAY:

People pay attention to what leaders consistently do. A short follow-up message. A delayed response. An update that never comes. A promise that is kept.

These moments communicate messages whether we intend them to or not. Notice that the right side of this slide is written in your team's voice, not yours. That is deliberate. Trust is often influenced less by what leaders say and more by what people repeatedly experience.

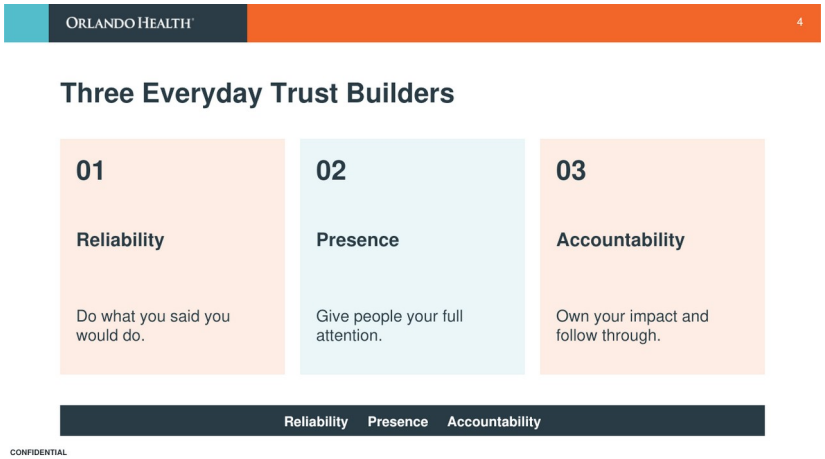
TRANSITION:

We will focus on three everyday behaviors that can support trust.

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Three Everyday Trust Builders



TIMING: 1:25 | 3:35–5:00

SAY:

We will focus on three everyday trust builders: Reliability, Presence, and Accountability.

Reliability means doing what you committed to do and communicating when plans change. Presence means giving people your attention. Accountability means owning your contribution and following through on repair when something goes wrong.

These behaviors can begin with ordinary interactions, although they still require attention, time, and realistic commitments. Consistency matters, and workload or process barriers may need attention too.

REFLECT:

Which behavior is easiest for you under pressure? Which is easiest to lose? Pause for 10 seconds.

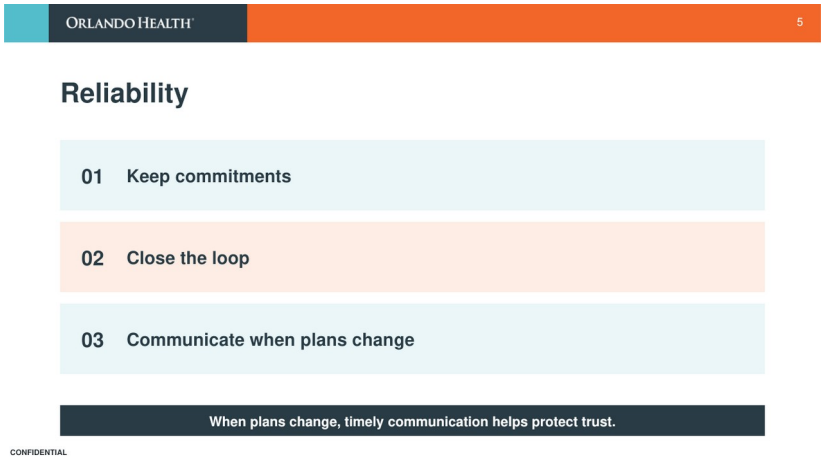
TRANSITION:

Let's begin with reliability.

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Reliability



TIMING: 1:25 | 5:00–6:25

SAY:

Reliability means people know they can depend on us. When plans change, timely communication helps protect trust. Repeated changes or missed commitments can still damage trust, even when explained. Make commitments you can realistically meet, and communicate early when a change is necessary.

Closing the loop matters. A simple update often protects trust, even when you do not yet have the answer. It sounds like this: "I committed to providing an answer today. I'm still gathering information, but I wanted to update you and will reconnect by Thursday." That message takes fifteen seconds.

Reliability creates predictability. And predictability strengthens trust.

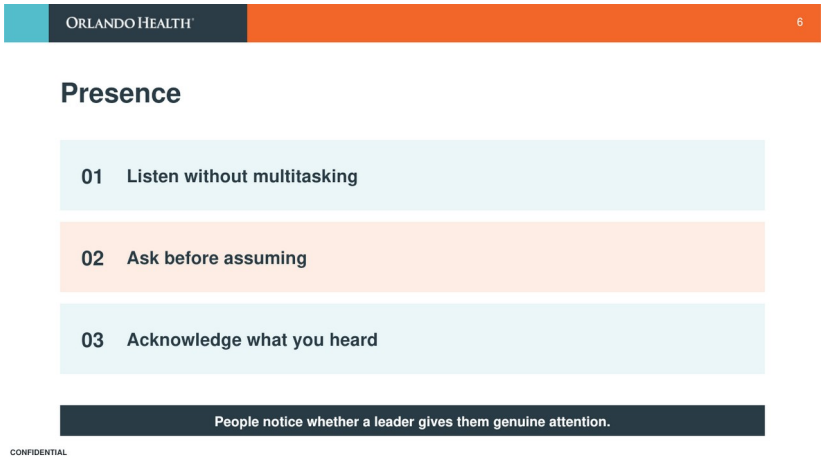
TRANSITION:

Trust also grows when people feel heard and understood.

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Presence



TIMING: 1:25 | 6:25–7:50

SAY:

Presence means giving people your attention. And presence is visible. Small behaviors communicate it: putting down the phone, turning away from the computer, asking one additional question instead of moving to the next thing, reflecting back what you heard.

People notice whether a leader gives them genuine attention. That may require time and intention. If you cannot give attention now, explain the constraint and agree on a time you can honor. Presence communicates respect. And respect strengthens trust.

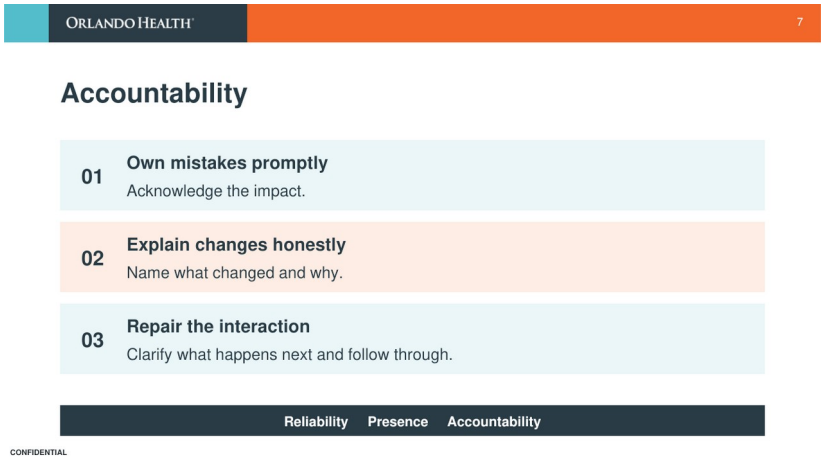
TRANSITION:

The third trust builder often matters most when things do not go as planned.

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Accountability



TIMING: 1:25 | 7:50–9:15

SAY:

Accountability means owning our contribution when something does not go as intended. Leaders build credibility when they acknowledge impact. not by over-apologizing, but by naming what happened and what comes next.

It sounds like this: "I realize I changed direction without explaining why. That created confusion. Let me clarify what has changed and what happens next."

Many leaders worry that owning a mistake costs them authority. Sincere ownership, followed by corrective action, can strengthen trust. People need to experience follow-through as well as hear an apology.

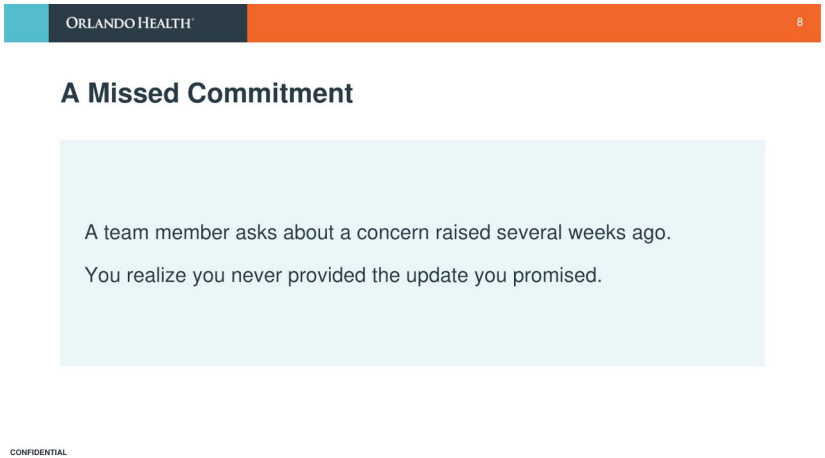
TRANSITION:

Let's look at what this can look like in practice.

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A Missed Commitment



TIMING: 2:15 | 9:15–11:30

SAY:

A team member asks for an update on a concern raised several weeks ago. You realize you never followed up as promised. They appear frustrated. Competing priorities contributed to the delay, but the team member may wonder whether the concern mattered.

ASK:

What would you say first, and what commitment could you realistically make now?

FACILITATE:

Give 20 seconds to think, then invite two brief responses. Listen for ownership before explanation. Avoid using the leader's workload as an excuse.

DEBRIEF:

Accountability: acknowledge the missed commitment and its impact.

Presence: listen to the concern and check what the team member needs now.

Reliability: give an honest update, agree on a realistic next step, and follow through.

EXAMPLE:

“I said I would update you and did not follow through. I understand why that is frustrating. Here is what I know today. I will reconnect with you by Thursday, even if I do not yet have a final answer.” Choose a follow-up time you can actually keep.

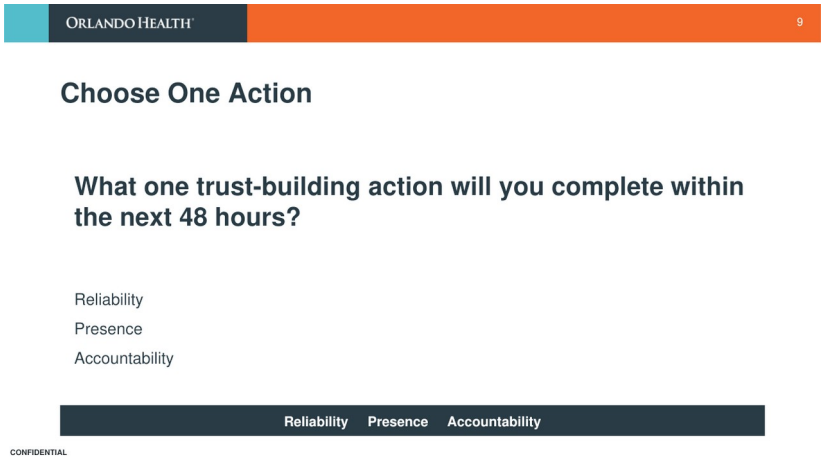
TRANSITION:

Now choose one trust-building action you can complete within the next 48 hours.

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Choose One Action



TIMING: 1:30 | 11:30–13:00

SAY:

Choose one trust-building action you will complete within the next 48 hours. Reliability may mean closing the loop on an update. Presence may mean giving someone your undivided attention. Accountability may mean revisiting an interaction and following through on repair.

CHAT ENGAGEMENT:

Allow 15 seconds to choose one action. Ask: “In the chat, share one trust-building action you will complete within the next 48 hours.” Pause 20 to 30 seconds. In person, invite two brief responses. Keep the same 48-hour timeframe when acknowledging commitments.

CLOSE:

Reliability. Presence. Accountability. Trust grows through the pattern others experience. Choose one specific action and follow through within the next 48 hours. Thank you for being here.